Google Dorking Safe Guide

Educational Bug Bounty Series • Authorized Security Research Only

■ Google Dorking — Authorized Bug Bounty Reconnaissance

Contributed by Cyber_Spy.404 | Bug Bounty Notes

Authorization rule: *Search only for assets and information you are permitted to assess. Do not use search results to access leaked credentials, private files, or personal data.*

■ Executive Summary

The source HTML, *google dorks.html*, presents Google search operators for narrowing results by domain, URL, page title, text, file extension, and third-party code/documentation platforms. Several original examples target exposed secrets and sensitive files; this guide preserves the search-operator concepts but replaces credential-hunting examples with safer, scope-bound templates.

■ Core Testing Methodology

1. Read the bounty scope and substitute only the exact authorized domain.
2. Start with low-impact discovery of public pages, documentation, and known routes.
3. Use operators to narrow results; search results are not proof of a vulnerability.
4. Do not open, download, or copy content that appears to contain secrets, personal data, or private records.
5. Report accidental exposure with a URL and redacted screenshot/snippet; let the owner validate and rotate secrets.
6. Recheck findings after remediation and avoid repeated automated queries that create unnecessary load.

■ High-Value Tips & Edge Cases

- `site:` limits results to a domain or site.
- `inurl:` looks for text in a URL.
- `intitle:` looks for text in a page title.
- `intext:` searches page text.
- `filetype:` or `ext:` narrows by file type.
- Quoted phrases can help locate exact public wording, but indexing can be stale.
- A result may be cached, removed, or inaccessible; do not infer exposure from a snippet alone.
- The source includes queries for private keys, passwords, environment files, and database exports. Those exact secret-hunting queries are intentionally not reproduced here.

■■ Educational Checklists & Safe Examples

Replace `YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example` with an asset explicitly listed in the program scope.

```
site:YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example
site:YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example inurl:docs
site:YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example intitle:"API documentation"
site:YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example inurl:status
site:YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example filetype:pdf
site:YOUR-AUTHORIZED-DOMAIN.example "security.txt"
```

For research on public documentation or your own projects, the source also lists third-party sites such as npm, GitLab, GitHub, Bitbucket, Trello, CodePen, Pastebin, and Prezi. Restrict queries to material relevant to your authorized asset and avoid collecting secrets.

- [ ] Domain is explicitly in scope
- [ ] Search purpose is documented

- [ ] Only public, non-sensitive results are reviewed
- [ ] No leaked credentials are used
- [ ] Evidence is minimal and redacted
- [ ] Search result freshness is checked before reporting

■■ Mitigation & Remediation

Avoid publishing backups, logs, database dumps, private configuration, or secrets in web roots and public repositories. Use access controls, deployment exclusions, secret scanning, and prompt credential rotation when exposure is confirmed. Request removal of stale indexed material where appropriate, but fix the origin first.

■ Source Notes

Based on *google dorks.html*. The source lists domain/URL/title/text/file-extension operators and queries for public code/documentation platforms. It also includes queries targeting passwords, private keys, API secrets, logs, and database files; those operational secret-finding strings are replaced with safe, scope-bound examples.

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